

Petition 5 — Simplify Fertilizer (Urea) Procurement for Genuine Farmers while Preventing Diversion

To: Shri M. Liju Hon'ble Minister for Co-operation, Government of Kerala Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: 1. Shri T. Siddique, Hon'ble Minister for Agriculture 2. Shri Anoop Jacob, Hon'ble Minister for Food, Civil Supplies & Consumer Affairs

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Request to simplify the procurement of urea and other subsidised fertilizers for genuine farmers — especially the elderly and tenant cultivators — while strengthening safeguards against diversion to the wrong persons.

1. Respected Sir,

Primary Agricultural Co-operative Societies (PACS) and co-operative outlets are the main channel through which our farmers buy fertilizer. The present procedure, though well-intentioned, has become **burdensome for genuine farmers** while still leaving gaps that allow diversion. We pray for a simpler, safer system.

2. The factual position

- 1. The current procedure — the exact position.** Fertilizer sale and movement are governed by the **Fertilizer (Control) Order, 1985** made under the **Essential Commodities Act, 1955**. The Union Department of Fertilizers introduced **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) in Fertilizers from October 2016** (pilot), launched the **Integrated Fertilizer Management System (iFMS) in June 2016**, and **completed the pan-India rollout on 1 March 2018**. Under the **Aadhaar-enabled Fertilizers Distribution System (AeFDS)**, all subsidised fertilizers — **urea, DAP, MOP, super-phosphate, etc.** — can be sold only through **Aadhaar-linked Point-of-Sale (PoS) machines with biometric authentication**, the buyer being identified via **Aadhaar / Kisan Credit Card / Voter ID**. Notably, the Department's own guidelines provide that the crop/area recommendation is **not binding** and sale is on a **"no-denial mode"** — a principle that should protect genuine farmers from being turned away for want of documents.
- 2. The difficulties on the ground.** In Palakkad, farmers report: - **Repeated demands for documents** — Aadhaar, and in practice **land-tax receipts / land records** — at every purchase; - **Fingerprint-authentication failures**, especially for **elderly farmers** and manual labourers; - **Exclusion of tenant / lease cultivators**, who till land they do not own and cannot readily produce land documents; - **Network / technical glitches** at PoS terminals, and problems with small-quantity purchases.
- 3. The genuine concern.** At the same time, safeguards are needed so that subsidised fertilizer is **not diverted** to non-agricultural / industrial use, bulk hoarders, or across the State border to the wrong persons.

3. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister for Co-operation (through whom the PACS network functions), in coordination with Agriculture and Civil Supplies, to:

- 1. Introduce a one-time verified "Farmer ID / registration"** — issued through the PACS and linked once to the farmer's **Aadhaar, land / registered-lease record and Soil Health Card** — so that documents such as land-tax receipts **need not be produced at every purchase**; the PoS simply reads the pre-verified entitlement.

2. **Permit biometric alternatives** (OTP / face authentication) and allow an **authorised family member or registered nominee** to purchase on behalf of elderly, ill or differently-abled farmers.
3. **Recognise registered tenant / lease cultivators** (through Padasekhara Samithis / lease registers / cultivation certificates from the Krishi Bhavan) so that landless-but-genuine farmers are not excluded.
4. **Do not insist on the land-tax receipt at each sale** once the one-time registration is complete.
5. **Strengthen anti-diversion safeguards** — enforce **crop-wise / area-wise entitlement ceilings** in the PoS / iFMS, flag abnormal or bulk purchases, and audit — so that fertilizer reaches only genuine cultivators and is blocked from wrong persons and cross-border diversion.
6. **Ensure adequate buffer stock and upgraded PoS connectivity** at PACS in Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara during the peak sowing season.

4. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Instances of document-related hardship (with dates / outlets).
- Annexure B: List of PACS outlets in the Chittur belt and their PoS status.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur

Annexure — Draft Government Order (model, for the Government's consideration)

The following is a model draft placed for the Government's consideration. The actual G.O. number, date and file references are to be assigned by the Department.

GOVERNMENT OF KERALA
Abstract

Co-operation Department — Sale of subsidised fertilizers through Primary Agricultural Co-operative Societies (PACS) — One-time Farmer Registration to simplify procurement for genuine farmers, and strengthened safeguards against diversion — Orders issued.

CO-OPERATION DEPARTMENT
G.O.(Ms) No. ____/2026/Co-op Thiruvananthapuram, dated __-__-2026

Read: 1. The Fertilizer (Control) Order, 1985 (under the Essential Commodities Act, 1955).
2. DoF DBT/AeFDS framework (iFMS, June 2016; pan-India w.e.f. 01-03-2018), providing for sale on "no-denial mode."
3. The Kerala Co-operative Societies Act, 1969.
4. Representation dated 15-07-2026 of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, forwarded by the MLA, Chittur.

ORDER

Whereas genuine farmers — especially the elderly and tenant cultivators — face hardship from repeated document demands and biometric failures at the point of sale, while diversion to wrong persons must be prevented;

Government, having considered the matter, hereby order that, through the co-operative (PACS) network —

- (1) a one-time verified "Farmer Registration / ID," linked once to Aadhaar, land / registered-lease record and Soil Health Card, shall be issued, so that documents (including land-tax receipts) are not demanded at every purchase;
- (2) biometric alternatives (OTP / face authentication) and purchase by an

- authorised family member / registered nominee shall be permitted for the elderly, ill and differently-abled;
- (3) registered tenant / lease cultivators (via Padasekhara Samithis / lease registers / Krishi Bhavan certificates) shall be recognised as eligible;
- (4) the land-tax receipt shall not be insisted upon at each sale once the one-time registration is complete;
- (5) crop-wise / area-wise entitlement ceilings shall be enforced in the PoS/iFMS, with flagging of bulk/abnormal purchases and audit, to block diversion and cross-border leakage; and
- (6) PACS in Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara shall be assured buffer stock and upgraded PoS connectivity during the peak season.

By order of the Governor,

Secretary to Government

To The Registrar of Co-operative Societies; the Director of Agriculture Development & Farmers' Welfare.

Copy to: Agriculture Dept.; Food & Civil Supplies Dept.; the MLA, Chittur.